

Shawn Cook

Software Engineering Manager

Results-driven and empathetic leader with a proven track record of delivering high-quality software projects on time while fostering motivated, engaged teams.

EXPERIENCE

Fountain, San Diego, CA –Staff Software Engineering Tech Lead

March 2024 – present

- Led a team to develop onboarding and compliance software for frontline workers hired by our clients, ensuring seamless integration and user experience.
- Managed full-stack development with a focus on TypeScript, React, Node.js, MongoDB, and event-driven cloud architecture.
- Collaborated closely with product and design teams to define project requirements, facilitating smooth execution and high-quality deliverables by the engineering team.
- Continuously enhanced engineering processes to maximize efficiency and collaboration with stakeholders, including engineers, leadership, product managers, designers, QA, and business developers.

Grindr, San Diego, CA –Software Engineering Manager

April 2022 – August 2023

- Led cross-functional teams in delivering world-class software for a globally recognized public company.
- Pioneered effective engineering strategies for teams of 5–15, enhancing process efficiency.
- Personally contributed as a staff-level engineer to critical backend and mobile projects.
- Skillfully gathered and negotiated requirements from diverse product and design teams.
- Attained an exceptional 90% on-time delivery rate with top-tier quality results.
- Aligned stakeholders of varying levels on quarterly and annual organizational goals.
- Shaped hiring strategies, assessing candidates from intern to director levels.

CONTACT INFO

Location: San Diego, CA

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EDUCATION

Master of Science – Software Engineering

Arizona State University –

Tempe, AZ

Aug 2008 – May 2012

Bachelor of Science – Computer Science

Arizona State University –

Tempe, AZ

Aug 2000 – May 2004

SKILLS / TOOLS

Team building & hiring

Project management

Java/Kotlin API services

Cloud (AWS, GCP, Azure)

Node/React/TS Full-Stack

Grindr, San Diego, CA –Staff Software Engineer

March 2021 – April 2022

- Spearheaded engineering efforts as a tech lead, focusing on user-facing features for a globally renowned brand.
- Directed the design process for backend systems, encompassing REST API services and complementary cloud architecture.
- Developed high-performance Java and Kotlin API services, seamlessly managing millions of requests per second alongside substantial daily and monthly active users.
- Designed the end-to-end lifecycle of cloud architecture, encompassing design, provisioning, configuration, deployment, and maintenance.
- Employed a tech stack comprising MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis cache, Kafka event streams, and RMQ event streams.

Sony Interactive Entertainment, San Diego, CA –Senior Software Engineer (contract)

May 2020 – March 2021

- Led engineering efforts as a tech lead, crafting user-facing features for a renowned global brand.
- Designed backend systems encompassing REST API services and underlying cloud architecture.
- Developed high-performance Java and Kotlin API services, efficiently managing millions of requests per second and substantial user engagement.
- Orchestrated end-to-end cloud architecture operations, employing MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis cache, Kafka event streams, and RMQ event streams.

Self Employed, San Diego, CA –Software Engineering Consultant

May 2018 – May 2020

- Developed JavaScript-based integrated system controls.
- Offered strategic consultation for Android consumer app development.
- Contributed to API redesign, full-stack analysis, and testing.
- Executed extensive UI redesign and automated UI tests using Espresso.
- Led React Native UI software development.
- Designed and implemented a comprehensive vending machine inventory management system, encompassing cloud architecture, machine vending software, electronics firmware, and IoT integration.
- Architected and executed cloud architecture (Google Cloud).
- Managed subcontractors, handling hiring and coordination.
- Provided strategic consultation, including cost and time estimates, system architecture, and business synthesis.

Yahoo!, San Diego, CA –Software Engineering Manager

January 2016 – May 2018

- Spearheaded talent acquisition for diverse roles including iOS, Android, Java, and Frontend developers. Managed the entire recruitment process from writing job postings to final candidate selection, even persuading top candidates with multiple offers.
- Provided technical leadership to a team working on various concurrent projects: iOS and Android development, distributed Java backend services, and React frontend web applications.
- Balanced priorities through regular face-to-face meetings, interfacing with stakeholders, and engaging with project management and corporate leadership.
- Designed project structures catering to a diverse engineering team, tracked progress, maintained Jira backlog, and conducted daily SCRUM standups to ensure engagement.
- Offered technical guidance, mentoring for junior engineers, led architectural design, and ensured optimal task focus and productivity.
- Nurtured team morale, encouraged work-life balance, and cultivated job satisfaction and fulfillment.

- Addressed interpersonal conflicts, promoting respect and inclusion among team members.
- Assembled and managed an eight-person team spanning frontend, backend, iOS, and Android roles.
- Conducted extensive technical interviews and campus recruiting trips.
- Performed individual performance reviews and resolved minor interpersonal issues for a cohesive and content team environment.

Yahoo!, San Diego, CA –Senior Software Engineer

July 2013 – January 2016

- Proficient in Java development, specializing in building backend and middle-tier systems designed for high traffic and availability.
- Skilled in crafting thread-safe, high-performance code capable of efficiently handling millions of requests per minute.
- Experienced in designing and maintaining distributed microservice architectures that ensure both high availability and throughput.
- Adept at working with external dependencies such as messaging systems, caching mechanisms, databases, and offline task processing.
- Well-versed in Spring development, utilizing Hibernate and JPA/CRUDRepository interfaces for seamless MySQL persistence.
- Expertise in integrating spring-data-redis with Redis Cluster to optimize object caching.
- Proficient in creating REST API microservices, with a strong foundation in using spring-boot for streamlined project initialization.
- Skilled in front-end web development, employing NodeJs and ReactJs to deliver dynamic and engaging user interfaces.
- Proficient in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and JQuery to create responsive and visually appealing web experiences.

Boeing, Mesa, AZ –Senior Software Engineer

December 2008 – January 2013

- Accomplished Java Developer with expertise in maintaining a substantial 2 million lines of code Java project, built as a collection of Eclipse plugins and OSGI bundles.
- Agile Scrum Master skilled in eliminating strategic and technical obstacles to enhance team productivity. Maintained team organization, delegation, and fostered a productive environment. Provided valuable mentoring and training to junior colleagues.
- Active participation in Earned Value (EV) project management activities.
- Proficiently implemented, tested, and maintained HMI architecture on Linux within various distributed and unified platform setups. Skillfully integrated external runtime libraries and custom hardware into C++ and QT-based GUI layer.
- Developed automated test utilities using C++, Python, and Bash shell scripts for streamlined testing processes.

Arizona State University, Tempe, AZ –Research Technologist

July 2007 – December 2008

- Utilized Objective C, C++, and Java to create immersive multimodal environments for projects centered on Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) research within the Arts, Media, and Engineering College (AME) at ASU (<http://ame.asu.edu/>).
- Revitalized a real-time 3D tracking camera system, resulting in enhanced response time, heightened stability, and the establishment of a well-documented, effective calibration process.
- Collaborated with research faculty and students, leveraging open-source graphics libraries and OpenGL to develop impactful 3D applications.
- Engineered custom, extensible network protocols for both UDP and TCP inter-process communication.
- Crafted cross-platform multimedia applications compatible with Mac OSX, Linux, and Windows environments.

Control Logic, Inc., Mesa, AZ –Senior Software Engineer

August 2004 – July 2007

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- Created multi-threaded, high-volume mail handling systems.
 - Utilized MS SQL Server and MySQL to implement tray routing systems, facilitating efficient data collection and analysis.
 - Employed MFC to design operator interfaces, including both single and multiple document views, for displaying and editing routing algorithms.
 - Collaborated on engineering teams of varying sizes, adapting to different roles as needed within the context.
- Experienced in team leadership, member contributions, consultancy, and individual development.
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